

Niklas Hlubek

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Epidemiologist with interdisciplinary background in psychology and public health, specialized in health inequalities. Expertise in applying advanced quantitative methods (multilevel modeling, time-to-event) to large-scale longitudinal cohort data. Proven ability to manage complex data linkage and translate research into actionable insights for policy and academic audiences. Committed to co-production and open science principles.

EDUCATION

- PhD. **Epidemiology**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, expected by End of 2025
MSc. **Social Policy and Public Health**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, 2022
MSc. **Psychological Research**, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh - SCO, 2021
BSc. **Psychology**, Erasmus University Rotterdam, Rotterdam - NL, 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2023 - 25 **Doctoral Research Fellow** - University Medical Center Utrecht - NL
Project: *Longitudinal socioeconomic disparities in environmental health associations*
- Designed and executed advanced quantitative analyses on longitudinal registry cohort data (>70M observations) to investigate socioeconomic patterns in environmental health inequalities
- Independently developed and implemented comprehensive data linkage pipelines integrating multiple registry and environmental data sources, establishing robust harmonization protocols and quality assurance frameworks
- Authored peer-reviewed manuscripts (1 published, 2 under review) and presented findings at international conferences to academic and policy audiences
- 2024 **Research Consultant** - Municipality Utrecht, Utrecht - NL
- Delivered evidence-based case report on city-level environmental inequalities for policy stakeholders
- 2024 **Visiting Researcher** - ISGlobal Barcelona Institute for Global Health, Barcelona - ESP
- Advanced spatial epidemiology and clustering methodologies for population health research
- Managed the harmonization and analysis of data from 2 longitudinal European cohorts
- 2022 **Policy and Projects Assistant** - Mental Health Europe, Brussels - BE
- Organized co-production workshops with diverse stakeholders and conducted European mental health policy analysis
- 2020 **Research Assistant** - University Medical Center Hamburg Eppendorf, Hamburg - DE
- Supported psychiatric interventions and contributed to clinical research protocols

GRANTS

- 2023-25 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions ITN Fellowship**
Full PhD fellowship within EU H2020 project SURREAL (surreal-itn.eu)

TEACHING & INVOLVEMENT

- 2024-25 **PhD Council Board Member**, Julius Center, University Medical Center Utrecht
- Representative responsible for communication between PhD candidates and Division Leadership
- 2023-25 **Teaching Assistant**, Evidence Based Case Reports, Utrecht University Medical Center
- Led interactive tutorials on systematic literature search methods for medical students

PUBLICATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Gehring, U., J. Boer et al. "Assessing the impact of changes in home location on adolescent lung function: an exposome-wide natural experiment" *Environment International*. Currently under review
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. "Area-level temporal trends in air pollution exposure across socioeconomic position groups in the Netherlands" *Health and Place*. Currently under review
- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. "Temporal Trends in Air Pollution Exposure across Socioeconomic Groups in the Netherlands." *Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health*.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph21080976>..
- 2022 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton, A., Wiseman-Gregg, K. "A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmission in hospital settings." *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/jasp.12948>.
- 2022 Bomke P., **Hlubek, N.** "Entwicklung der Sozialpsychiatrie in Europa - die Sicht von Mental Health Europe" *Kerbe - Forum fuer soziale Psuychatrie*.
- 2021 Moritz S., Xie J., Penney D., Biehl L., **Hlubek, N.**, Elmers J., Beblo T., Hottenrott B. "The magnitude of neurocognitive impairment is overestimated in depression: the role of motivation, debilitating momentary influences, and the overreliance on mean differences." *Psychological Medicine*. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291721004785>.
- 2020 Jelinek L., **Hlubek, N.**, Moritz S., Miegel F., Voderholzer U. "Zwangsstörungen während COVID-19: Sind Menschen mit Waschzwängen besonders betroffen." *z-aktuell*.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Verhoeven J., Wagtendonk A., Hoek G., Vaartjes I., "Air pollution and ischemic stroke across socioeconomic groups in the Netherlands: A Prospective Registry Study" Project presented at the **ESC Preventive Cardiology** Conference, Milano (2025)
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.** "Equity in exposure" Presentation at **UBD Policy Workshop on Equity in Health Impact Assessment** (ubdpolicy.eu), Utrecht (2025)
- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, et al. "Impact of exposome relocation trajectories on childhood lung function" Project presented to the annual **EXPANSE meeting**, Munich (2024)
- 2022 Templeton A., **Hlubek, N.** "Social identity processes in hospital workers risk perception and adherence to safety guidance during the COVID-19 pandemic." Paper presented at the **BPS Social Psychology Section Annual Conference**, Online (2022)
- 2021 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton A. "A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmissions in hospital settings – Barriers and avenues to safe behavior in healthcare workers." Project presented to the **Scottish Government COVID-19 Nosocomial Review Group**, Online (2021)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Statistical & Computing

R: lme4, lavaan, survival, tidyverse
Python (basic), Git/GitHub, Markdown/Quarto
Large-scale data analysis (70M+ observations)
Registry & cohort data linkage

Methods & Languages

Multilevel modeling, SEM, survival analysis
Causal inference (DAGs, propensity scores)
German (native), English (fluent)

RELEVANT TRAINING & WORKSHOPS

2024	Causal Inference and Causal Data Science , Utrecht University
2023	Modern Method in Data Analysis , Utrecht University
2021	Evidence Based Psychological Interventions , University of Edinburgh
2021	Social Inequality and Child and Adolescent Mental Health , University of Edinburgh